

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- A new independent report, "The Cost of Waiting," warns that prolonged delays in SEND provision increase safeguarding and welfare risk for vulnerable children, drawing on FOI responses from 16 local authorities.
→ **For your school:** Useful evidence if you're pressing a local authority on interim provision while a child awaits an EHCP or specialist placement.
- DfE's fortnightly sector bulletin (DfE Update, 9 September) went out this week — worth a scan for any grant deadlines or data-collection asks relevant to your school.
→ **For your school:** Check the update for anything time-limited that affects your setting.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

18 Sep 2026 — DfE EOTAS (education otherwise than at school) consultation closes.

18 Sep 2026 — Rotherham Schools Forum meets — agenda includes the exclusion & suspensions annual report and an EHCP update.

■ INCLUSION & SEND

- **"The Cost of Waiting" — new report on SEND delays.** The report examines what happens when children with SEND can't access suitable education for prolonged periods, arguing schools should weigh the wider educational, emotional and safeguarding implications of reduced timetables or waits for specialist placement, and calls for more consistent recognition of urgency across local authorities. ([Nasen](#))
→ **For your school:** A citable source if you're escalating a case where interim provision has stalled.

■ NATIONAL POLICY & FUNDING

- **DfE Update, 9 September 2026.** The department's regular fortnightly bulletin to schools and trusts was published this week; it typically covers grant deadlines, data-collection windows and operational guidance rather than headline policy. ([GOV.UK](#))

FROM THE CORRIDOR

It's a quiet weekend on the national wires — the next few days are a good moment to catch up on the EOTAS consultation before it closes 18 September.

Editor's note

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

■ SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.